

REGRET

1. Passage anchor

> “In other words, the story explores **regret**, missed opportunities, and the question of whether a ‘perfect life’ really exists.”

Passage meaning

regret = sadness, disappointment, or painful reflection about something that happened or did not happen in the past

後悔；遺憾

Here, the novel explores the feeling of looking back at past choices and wondering whether life could have turned out differently.

Practice

1. The novel explores **regret** and the choices people wish they had made differently.
這本小說探討**後悔**以及人們希望當初能作出不同選擇的心情。

2. She felt deep **regret** about the opportunity she had missed.
她對錯過的機會感到深深的**遺憾**。

Core meanings of REGRET

2. regret — noun: sadness about the past

= sadness or disappointment because of something that happened, something you did, or something you failed to do

後悔；遺憾

This is the exact passage sense.

Examples

1. He spoke with obvious **regret** about the decision.
他談起那個決定時明顯帶著**後悔**。

2. She has no **regrets** about changing careers.
她對轉行這件事**毫不後悔**。

3. regret about / over something

= sadness or disappointment concerning a past event or decision

對.....感到後悔 / 遺憾

Examples

1. He expressed **regret over** what had happened.
他對發生的事情表示**遺憾**。

2. She felt **regret about** leaving so suddenly.
她對自己突然離開感到**後悔**。

Verb: wish you had acted differently

4. regret something

= feel sorry or unhappy about something you did, said, chose, etc.

後悔 ; 懊悔

Examples

1. I **regret that decision**.
我**後悔那個決定**。

2. She immediately **regretted her words**.
她立刻**後悔自己說了那些話**。

5. regret doing something

= feel sorry about something you have already done

後悔做過某事

Examples

1. I **regret saying** that.
我**後悔說了那句話**。

2. He **regretted leaving** the job so quickly.
他**後悔那麼快離職**。

Very high-value grammar pattern.

6. regret not doing something

= wish you had done something that you did not do

後悔沒有做某事

Examples

1. She **regrets not studying** abroad.

她**後悔當初沒有出國留學**。

2. I **regret not asking** more questions.

我**後悔當時沒有多問一些問題**。

This is especially relevant to the passage theme of “what ifs.”

Formal bad-news use

7. regret to do something

Formal:

= be sorry to have to say or inform someone of something unpleasant

遺憾地.....；很抱歉要.....

Examples

1. We **regret to inform you** that your application was unsuccessful.

我們**很遺憾地通知你**，你的申請未獲接納。

2. I **regret to say** that the event has been cancelled.

我**很遺憾地表示**，活動已取消。

This is different from **regret doing**.

8. regret that...

= formally express sadness or disappointment about a situation

遺憾.....

Examples

1. We **regret that** the service was delayed.
我們對服務延誤深表**遺憾**。
2. I **regret that** we cannot offer further assistance.
很**遺憾**我們無法提供進一步協助。

Noun: a regretted thing

9. a regret

= something in your past that you wish had been different
一件後悔的事；遺憾之事

Examples

1. My biggest **regret** is not travelling more when I was younger.
我最大的**遺憾**是年輕時沒有多旅行。
2. He described the decision as one of his few **regrets**.
他把那個決定形容為自己少數幾件**後悔的事**之一。

10. no regrets

= no feelings of wishing the past had been different
無怨無悔；不後悔

Examples

1. I have **no regrets** about the choice I made.
我對自己的選擇**毫不後悔**。
2. She left with **no regrets**.
她離開時**沒有任何遺憾**。

Polite regret / apology-like use

11. express regret

= formally state that you are sorry about something

****表示遺憾****

Examples

1. The company ****expressed regret**** over the mistake.

公司對這項錯誤****表示遺憾****。

2. He ****expressed deep regret**** for his comments.

他對自己的言論****深表遺憾****。

This can overlap with apology language, but it is not always the same as accepting blame.

12. with regret

= sadly; while feeling sorry about something

****遺憾地；抱歉地****

Examples

1. ****With regret****, we must decline the invitation.

我們只好****遺憾地****婉拒邀請。

2. She accepted his resignation ****with regret****.

她****很遺憾地****接受了他的辭呈。

Related forms

13. regretful

= feeling or showing regret

****後悔的；遺憾的****

Examples

1. He sounded ****regretful****.

他聽起來很****後悔****。

2. She gave me a ****regretful smile****.

她帶著****遺憾的笑容****看著我。

14. regretfully

A. with regret / sadly

****遺憾地；抱歉地****

1. She ****regretfully**** declined the offer.
她****遺憾地****拒絕了這個提議。

B. in a way showing personal regret

****懊悔地****

2. He looked back ****regretfully****.
他****懊悔地****回望。

15. regrettable

= unfortunate and worthy of regret
****令人遺憾的；可惜的****

Examples

1. It was a ****regrettable mistake****.
那是一個****令人遺憾的錯誤****。
2. The delay was ****regrettable****.
這次延誤很****可惜 / 令人遺憾****。

Important distinction from ****regretful****.

16. regrettably

= unfortunately; sadly
****令人遺憾的是；可惜地****

Examples

1. ****Regrettably****, the event has been cancelled.
****很遺憾****，活動已取消。

2. The plan, **regrettably**, could not continue.

很**可惜**，計畫無法繼續。

High-value patterns

17. live with regret

= continue carrying painful feelings about a past decision or event

帶著後悔生活；一直心存遺憾

Examples

1. He did not want to **live with regret**.

他不想一直**帶著後悔生活**。

2. She chose to act rather than **live with regret**.

她選擇採取行動，而不是日後**心存遺憾**。

18. have second thoughts / regret a decision

These are related but not identical.

regret a decision

= wish the decision had been different after making it

後悔某個決定

have second thoughts

= begin to doubt a decision, possibly before it is final

開始猶豫；重新考慮

19. to my regret

= causing me regret; unfortunately from my point of view

令我遺憾的是

Examples

1. **To my regret**, I never saw him again.

令我遺憾的是，我後來再也沒有見過他。

2. ****To her regret****, the opportunity had already passed.

****令她遺憾的是****，那個機會已經錯過了。

Key contrasts

20. regret vs remorse

****regret****

= broad sadness or wishing something had been different

****後悔；遺憾****

****remorse****

= stronger moral guilt about having done something wrong

****悔恨；自責****

Compare:

> I regret missing the opportunity.

> 我後悔錯過機會。

> He felt remorse for hurting her.

> 他因傷害她而深感悔恨。

21. regret vs guilt

****guilt****

= feeling responsible for wrongdoing

****罪惡感；內疚****

****regret****

= can occur even when no wrongdoing happened

****後悔；遺憾****

You can regret:

* choosing the wrong course

* missing a train

* not travelling

without feeling guilty.

22. regret vs disappointment

****disappointment****

= sadness because reality did not meet expectations

****失望****

****regret****

= looks backward and often involves wishing something had happened differently

****後悔；遺憾****

23. regret vs sorry

****sorry****

= broad adjective for apology, sympathy, or regret

****抱歉的；難過的****

****regret****

= noun/verb focused more specifically on wishing a past action or situation were different

Compare:

> I'm sorry I hurt you.

> 我很抱歉傷害了你。

> I regret hurting you.

> 我後悔傷害了你。

The second sounds more reflective and formal.

24. regret doing vs regret to do

This distinction is essential.

regret doing

= feel sorry about something already done

****後悔做了某事****

> I regret telling him.

> 我後悔告訴了他。

regret to do

= be sorry that you must now say/do something unpleasant

很遺憾要.....

> I regret to tell you that...

> 我很遺憾地告訴你.....

These are not interchangeable.

25. regretful vs regrettable

regretful

= person feels regret

感到後悔的

> a regretful person

> 一個感到後悔的人

regrettable

= situation deserves regret

令人遺憾的

> a regrettable mistake

> 一個令人遺憾的錯誤

Meaning map

The central concept of **regret** is:

looking back at something and wishing it had been different

From this develop:

Passage

regret

→ **對人生選擇的後悔 / 遺憾**

Verb

regret a decision

→ **後悔某個決定**

Completed action

regret doing

→ **後悔做過某事**

Missed action

regret not doing

→ **後悔沒有做某事**

Formal bad news

regret to inform

→ **很遺憾地通知**

Regretted event

a regret

→ **一件遺憾的事**

Emotional adjective

regretful

→ **感到後悔的**

Situation adjective

regrettable

→ **令人遺憾的**

The passage uses the broad **retrospective emotional** branch:

- > looking back at choices
- > imagining other possible lives
- > feeling **regret**

→ **後悔 / 遺憾**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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regret — noun feeling	因過去的決定、行動或錯失而希望事情不同；後悔 / 遺憾	
regret about/over something	對某件已發生的事情感到後悔或遺憾	
regret — verb	對自己做過、說過或選擇過的事情感到後悔	
regret doing something	後悔自己已經做過某事	
regret not doing something	後悔自己當初沒有做某事	
regret to do something	正式用法：很遺憾現在必須說 / 通知某件不好的事情	
regret that...	對某情況正式表示遺憾	
a regret	一件希望當初能不同的後悔 / 遺憾之事	
no regrets	對過去的選擇沒有後悔	
express regret	正式表示對某件事情感到遺憾	
with regret	帶著遺憾地；很遺憾地	
regretful	自己感到或表現出後悔的	
regretfully	帶著後悔 / 遺憾地	
regrettable	情況、行為等令人遺憾的	
regrettably	很遺憾地；令人遺憾的是	
live with regret	長期帶著對過去的後悔 / 遺憾生活	
to my regret	令我感到遺憾的是	

Passage recap

> “...the story explores ****regret****, missed opportunities, and the question of whether a ‘perfect life’ really exists.”

Here:

****regret**** = ****painful reflection on past choices or missed possibilities, accompanied by a wish that things had been different****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****後悔****

* ****遺憾****

* contextually: ****對人生選擇的遺憾****

Natural contextual translation:

****這個故事探討的是後悔、錯失的機會，以及所謂「完美人生」是否真的存在。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****regret****

= ****sadness or disappointment about something in the past, especially because you wish you had acted differently****

****後悔；遺憾****

The most important grammar contrast is:

> ****regret doing****

> → 後悔****已經做了****某事

but:

> ****regret to do****

> → ****很遺憾現在必須****說 / 通知某事

And emotionally:

> ****regret****

> → broadly wishing the past were different

whereas:

> ****remorse****

> → stronger moral guilt for having done something wrong.

In the passage, ****regret**** is the broader reflective feeling at the heart of imagining all those different “what if” lives.